SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #48 · MIRACLES & BLESSING

“My words create my reality, so I must ‘name it and claim it.’”

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Where it often comes from

Teaching that faith-filled words have power to bring health, wealth, or success. Fear that saying something negative will make it happen. Hope for control in a situation that feels uncontrollable. Popular “positive confession” books and preachers. Times when speaking positively seemed to help.

What Scripture teaches

Our words matter: they can encourage or wound, and we should speak with faith and truth. But Scripture teaches that God, not our words, determines outcomes. A person plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps. James warns against confidently announcing our plans and teaches us to say, “If the Lord is willing.” We pray according to God’s will, trusting Him with the result, rather than trying to force reality with our words.

> *“Come now, you who say, ‘Today or tomorrow we will go to this or that city, spend a year there, carry on business, and make a profit.’ You do not even know what will happen tomorrow! What is your life? You are a mist that appears for a little while and then vanishes. Instead, you ought to say, ‘If the Lord is willing, we will live and do this or that.’”* **(James 4:13–15)**.

Also see

> “A man’s heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps” **(Proverbs 16:9)**.
>
> “Many plans are in a man’s heart, but the purpose of the LORD will prevail” **(Proverbs 19:21)**.
>
> “Who has spoken and it came to pass, unless the Lord has ordained it?” **(Lamentations 3:37)**.
>
> “And this is the confidence that we have before Him: If we ask anything according to His will, He hears us” **(1 John 5:14)**.

Common self-statements

- If I say it with enough faith, it will happen.
- Saying something negative will make it come true.
- I have to claim my healing even if I’m still sick.
- My confession controls my future.
- I can’t admit I’m struggling, or I’ll make it worse.
- God has to do what I declare.

Common logical errors

- **Magical thinking:** Believing your words have power to control events.
- **Fear-based thinking:** Being afraid that honest words will cause bad outcomes.
- **Denial:** Refusing to admit real problems so as not to “confess” them.
- **Reversing roles:** Treating God as obligated to carry out your declarations.

Challenging questions

- Who determines my steps, according to Proverbs 16:9?
- What does James say I should add to my plans?
- Can my words overrule God's purposes?
- Did the psalmists speak honestly about their troubles?
- Am I trying to control the future out of fear?
- Is praying "Your will be done" a lack of faith, or the heart of faith?
- What is the difference between speaking faith and demanding outcomes?

Truth summary

> My words matter, but they do not create my reality. God determines my steps, and His purposes will prevail. I can speak honestly about my struggles, speak words of faith and encouragement, and pray boldly, while trusting God to decide the outcome. I can say, "If the Lord is willing."

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Prayer, Answers to
- Faith
- Plans
- Trust

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My words create my reality, so I must 'name it and claim it.'"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My words create my reality, so I must 'name it and claim it.'" I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who determines my steps?
- ☐ What does James say I should add to my plans?
- ☐ Can my words overrule God?
- ☐ Did the psalmists speak honestly about trouble?
- ☐ Am I trying to control the future out of fear?
- ☐ Is "Your will be done" the heart of faith?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God determines my steps.
- ☐ The purpose of the LORD will prevail.
- ☐ I can speak honestly about my struggles.
- ☐ I can pray boldly and trust God with the answer.
- ☐ My words can encourage, but they do not control reality.
- ☐ If the Lord is willing, I will do this or that.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **James 4:13–15**
  "Come now, you who say, 'Today or tomorrow we will go to this or that city, spend a year there, carry on business, and make a profit.' You do not even know what will happen tomorrow! What is your life? You are a mist that appears for a little while and then vanishes. Instead, you ought to say, 'If the Lord is willing, we will live and do this or that.'"
- [ ] **Proverbs 16:9**
  "A man's heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps."
- [ ] **Proverbs 19:21**
  "Many plans are in a man's heart, but the purpose of the LORD will prevail."
- [ ] **Lamentations 3:37**
  "Who has spoken and it came to pass, unless the Lord has ordained it?"
- [ ] **1 John 5:14**
  "And this is the confidence that we have before Him: If we ask anything according to His will, He hears us."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Honest prayer log:** Each day, write one honest prayer about a real problem, ending with "Your will be done."
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Proverbs 16:9 becomes: "**Sarah's** heart plans **her** course, but the LORD determines **her** steps."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Will of God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Say one honest sentence about a struggle** to God or a trusted friend, and notice that nothing bad happens because you said it.
- ☐ **Add "if the Lord is willing"** to your plans this week, and notice how it feels.
- ☐ **Read Jesus' prayer in Gethsemane in Matthew 26:39,** and write how He combined honesty with trust.
- ☐ **Use your words to encourage one person each day** this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My words create my reality, so I must 'name it and claim it.'": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One honest prayer I prayed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My words create my reality, so I must 'name it and claim it.'~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You determine my steps and that Your purposes prevail. Help me reject the lie that my words create my reality. Teach me to speak honestly, to pray boldly, and to say, "Your will be done." Let my words build others up and honor You. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.